Dead Mall Arena — Player's Manual

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What Is This?

Dead Mall Arena is a fully playable 3D first-person shooter that runs entirely inside a single HTML file — no installs, no downloads, no external assets. Every texture, sound effect, and piece of music is generated procedurally right in your browser.

You play as an operator dropped into a sprawling, abandoned 90s shopping mall now overrun by hostile alien species. It's part shooter, part haunted dead-mall exploration game: beyond the firefights, there's a go-kart museum with memorial plaques, a movie theater looping original footage, a dive bar with a working pool table and jukebox, a fortune teller whose readings might heal you or drag you to Hell, and a CompUSA guarded by an unhinged ex-employee who wants to know if you're there for a Mac.

It supports both single-player (against AI bots) and multiplayer — including a mode that works with zero server or backend at all.

Getting Started

On the deploy screen: enter a **callsign** (or leave blank for a random one), optionally enter a **party code** to play a private match with friends (blank = public shared arena), and check **low-power mode** if you're on weaker hardware like a Raspberry Pi.

Controls

Key	Action
WASD	Move
Mouse	Look
Hold click	Fire
R	Reload
E	Interact (shops, fortune teller, bar, jukebox, pool table, darts, vending machines)

Key	Action
G	Throw grenade
Y / N	Answer a yes/no question (e.g. the CompUSA employee)
M	Toggle ambient music
T	Open text chat
Esc	Release mouse cursor

Weapons & Combat

Everyone spawns with a random weapon. Kill a bot or another player and you automatically take their weapon.

Weapon	Notes
Sawed-Off Shotgun	Wide spread, high close-range damage
Pistol	Balanced sidearm
SMG	Fast fire rate
Rifle	Mid-range accuracy
Sniper	Long-range, high single-shot damage
RPG	Fortune Teller exclusive — behaves like a thrown grenade with an arc and blast radius

Your health is shown as **Integrity** on the HUD. It regenerates only through med-kits, the bar, or vending-machine food — there's no passive regen. Hostile alien species patrol the mall and will engage on sight; some (like Big Vinny the gangster) are far tougher than standard bots.

Power-Ups & Pickups

Scattered around the mall:

- **Med-kits** — restore health

- **Weapon crates** — random weapon pickup
- **Speed boost** — temporary movement speed increase
- **Shield** — absorbs incoming damage
- **Cloaking device** — temporary invisibility
- **Vending machines** (scattered around the atrium) — press E for a random item: food heals you, pop gives a speed boost. Each machine has a short cooldown between uses.

The Mall — Map & Locations

Ground floor: a central atrium (with a dry fountain and benches) surrounded by 40 storefronts, plus four seasonal display corners — Christmas, Valentine's, Halloween, and Easter. An escalator near the atrium leads upstairs.

Second floor, under a tall metal-and-glass skylight ceiling:

Location	What's there
Galaxy Arcade	Arcade cabinets, skee-ball
Starlite Pizza Cafe	Working conveyor belt kitchen, soda machine
Art Van Furniture	Furniture showroom
Kmart	Big-box store layout
Movie Theater	Looping original footage between showings
Kart Museum	Go-kart displays with memorial plaques
Sears	TVs and tools sections
Fortune Teller	Pay Integrity for a random weighted outcome
Dive Bar	Pool table, jukebox, dart board, bar (drunk mechanic)
Grenade Stand	Trade for grenades
CompUSA	Mac displays, guarded by The Ex-Genius

Enemies & Special Characters

- **AI bot operators / alien species** — 6 standard hostile bots patrolling the ground floor, each carrying a random weapon.
- **Creepy tall figures** (4 of them, upstairs) — creep toward you only while you're not looking at them, freeze the instant you spot them, and audibly breathe once they're close. Shootable.
- **Animatronic** — sits you down and tells the mall's history across 14 story lines when you approach and interact.
- **Big Vinny** — a gangster, summonable via a Fortune Teller outcome. Spawns center-stage upstairs, yells, approaches, and fires in telegraphed 3-second bursts with pauses between — giving you a window to react.
- **The Ex-Genius** — guards CompUSA. Gets close and asks **"Are you here to get a new Mac? (Y/N)"**. Answer **Y** and he's permanently friendly. Answer **N** and he turns hostile, taunting (including audibly ranting even when you can't see him) and shooting until you kill him — he resets and asks again after respawning.